



The Power of Speech

>>After smartphones and home assistants, now you can talk to the Internet> by Koustav Ray

INTRODUCTION

They say that a few words could bring down entire empires, start a war or cause a revolution. We speak to express. Voice has been the primary medium of communication between humans.

Wouldn't it be wonderful if you could speak to the web pages on your screen and tell them what to do and they in turn would respond to your instructions. Imagine the power that voice recognition could bring to modern web applications. From filling forms, searching using your voice, replying to your mail, chatting while playing an online game, or just plain navigational controls to telling web sites to show you your favourite movie or play your favourite song, the possibilities are truly endless.

Voice recognition has been around for quite some time with Native Operating Systems as well as with smartphones and other smart devices. Google Now, Siri or Cortana are widely used by the common man in mobile devices today. Be it high performance fighter aircraft terminals, VOIP telephony, gaming or handsfree computing, speech recognition has already played significant roles.

However, the web hasn't seen major adoption or usage of voice recognition or voice controlled commands. This has been vastly due to the unavailability of any good speech recognition capabilities of the browsers as well as due to the lack of initial

support from HTML regarding the same. Therefore speech recognition is yet to be popular as a medium of interaction between the user and the web.

But Google Chrome rolled out a speech recognition engine bundled with its browser in its version 25. So you can now invite users to talk to your web applications and process their speech in various languages recognised around the world.

WHY ANNYYANG?

The library that we are going to use today is known as "annyang" written by a well known open source contributor named Tal Ater.

The reason we chose this library is primarily due to the following facts:

- Uses the highly accurate speech recognition engine provided by Chrome.
- It's pretty lightweight (just 2kb when minified).
- Progressively enhances browsers that support speech recognition, while leaving users with older browsers unaffected.
- No external dependencies are required.
- Can be easily integrated with Speech KITT, A flexible GUI for interacting with Speech Recognition (Also written by Tal Ater).
- It's free to use!

*Coding Matters



*Cmd Prompt Replaced

>>Microsoft has replaced Command prompt with Powershell in the latest build of Windows 10.

<http://dgit.in/ByeByeCMD>



*Visual Studio for Mac

>>Microsoft announced Visual Studio for Mac with macOS based IDE, available as preview release.

<http://dgit.in/VSMacOS>



*x86 on ARM alive?

>> Microsoft may be working on emulator enabling ARM systems to run x86 applications, say sources.

<http://dgit.in/x86ARM>